

## Round two, Rural R&D for Profit summary of approved projects

On 1 July 2016 the Hon. Barnaby Joyce MP, the Minister for Agriculture, announced funding of \$52.2 million from 2015-16 to 2019-20 for 17 projects in round two of the Rural R&D for Profit Program. This funding will be matched by more than \$77 million in cash and in-kind contributions by research and development corporations and their partners. The application period for the second round of funding opened on 23 September 2015, and closed 1 December 2015.

The successful projects will all contribute to the program objective – to realise productivity and profitability improvements for primary producers.

| Project title                                                                                                                 | Applicant                                                                     | Grant funding awarded (GST excl) | Applicant/partner contributions (GST excl.) | Contributors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Summary                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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| Securing Pollination for More Productive Agriculture: Guidelines for effective pollinator management and stakeholder adoption | Rural Industries Research and Development Corporation (AgriFutures Australia) | \$5,255,000                      | \$2,627,714 cash \$5,227,563 in-kind        | HorticultureInnovation Australia Limited; University of Sydney; University of Adelaide; University of New England; Australian National University; SA Department of Primary Industries and Resources; SA Department of Environment, Water and Natural Resources; O'Connor NRM; Native Vegetation Council; Trees for Life; Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation; Lucerne Australia; South Australia Apiarist Association; Apple and Pear Growers Association of South Australia; Costa Group; Australian Melon | The project will realise significant productivity and profitability gains for farmers by improving yield and rates of pollination. The project will assess the contribution of pollinators to nine crops, re-establish native vegetation to support pollinator food and nesting resources, and use new technologies to communicate the findings to crop farmers. |

Association; Australian  
Mango Industry  
Association; Terrestrial  
Ecosystems Research  
Network; Greening  
Australia; Almond  
Board of Australia;  
Adelaide and Mount  
Lofty Ranges Natural  
Resources Management  
Board; Natural Resource  
Northern and Yorke;  
Raspberries and  
Blackberries Australia

The project will  
develop a better  
understanding of  
factors  
influencing the  
risk of Q fever  
spread within  
and between  
Australian  
ruminant  
livestock  
enterprises, and  
develop national  
guidelines for an  
emergency  
response plan to  
be used in the  
event of Q fever  
outbreak in  
humans.

Taking the Q  
(query) out of  
Q fever:  
developing a  
better  
understanding  
of the drivers  
of Q fever  
spread in  
farmed  
ruminants

Rural  
Industries  
Research  
and  
Development  
Corporation  
(AgriFutures  
Australia)

\$514,500

\$735,000 cash  
\$367,800 in-  
kind

University of  
Melbourne; Meredith  
Dairy; Australian  
Rickettsial Research  
Laboratory; University  
of Sydney; University of  
Queensland; University  
of Adelaide; Charles  
Sturt University; Goat  
Veterinary  
Consultancies

New  
biocontrol  
solutions for  
sustainable  
management  
of weed  
impacts on

Rural  
Industries  
Research  
and  
Development  
Corporation  
(AgriFutures  
Australia)

\$6,230,437

\$3,179,818 cash  
\$3,603,635 in-  
kind

Grains Research and  
Development  
Corporation;  
Commonwealth  
Scientific and Industrial  
Research Organisation;  
VIC Department of  
Economic Development,  
Jobs, Transport and

The project will  
improve the  
profitability of  
farmers by  
developing new  
biocontrol  
solutions for ten  
priority weed  
species across

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| agricultural<br>profitability | Resources; NSW<br>Department of Primary<br>Industries; QLD<br>Department of<br>Agriculture and<br>Fisheries; SA<br>Department of Primary<br>Industries and Regions;<br>Seqwater; Shire of<br>Ravensthorpe; NSW<br>Weed Biocontrol<br>Taskforce; North West<br>Local Land Services;<br>NSW Office of<br>Environment &<br>Heritage; Bundaberg<br>Regional Council;<br>Gladstone Regional<br>Council; HQPlantations;<br>Goulburn-Murray Water<br>Corporation;<br>Murrumbidgee<br>Irrigation Ltd;<br>Coleambally Irrigation<br>Cooperative Ltd;<br>Goulburn Broken<br>Catchment Management<br>Authority; Murray Local<br>Land Services; United<br>States Department of<br>Agriculture -<br>Agricultural Research<br>Service, Australian<br>Biological Control<br>Laboratory; Wyong<br>Shire Council; NSW<br>National Parks Service;<br>Central Murray County<br>Council;Murrumbidgee<br>Landcare Inc.; NQ Dry<br>Tropics |                     | multiple<br>agriculture<br>sectors. Experts<br>from Australia<br>and international<br>research agencies<br>will work<br>together to<br>develop new<br>biocontrol agents<br>to target weed<br>species of<br>national<br>significance,<br>weeds that are<br>difficult to<br>control with<br>current methods<br>and weeds that<br>have substantial<br>impacts on<br>agriculture<br>productivity. |
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| Phosphorus<br>Efficient       | \$3,460,000                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | \$1,730,000<br>cash | Dairy Australia Limited;<br>Australian Wool                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                     | The project will<br>reduce the                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

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| Pastures:<br>delivering high<br>nitrogen and<br>water use<br>efficiency, and<br>reducing costs<br>of production<br>across<br>Southern<br>Australia | Meat and<br>Livestock<br>Australia | \$3,247,829 in-<br>kind                                           | Innovation Limited;<br>Commonwealth<br>Scientific and Industrial<br>Research Organisation;<br>NSW Department of<br>Primary Industries;<br>University of Western<br>Australia; Murdoch<br>University; Bookham<br>Agricultural Bureau;<br>Tablelands Farming<br>Systems; Central Ranges<br>Grassland Society;<br>Monaro Farming<br>Systems; Association for<br>Sheep Husbandry,<br>Excellence, Evaluation<br>and Production<br>(ASHEEP); Southern<br>Dirt; Boggabri grazing<br>group; Purlewaugh NSW<br>Farmers | phosphorus<br>dependence of<br>Australian<br>farmers by<br>delivering<br>pasture systems<br>that require less<br>phosphorus<br>fertiliser. This<br>will achieve<br>multiple benefits<br>including<br>nitrogen use<br>efficiency, water<br>efficiency and<br>improved<br>productivity for<br>Australia's<br>pasture systems.<br>The project will<br>also develop the<br>knowledge and<br>necessary<br>protocols to<br>equip and inform<br>farmers about<br>how to improve<br>their phosphorus<br>efficiency. |
| Improved<br>surveillance,<br>preparedness<br>and return to<br>trade for<br>emergency<br>animal disease<br>incursions<br>using FMD as<br>a model    | Meat and<br>Livestock<br>Australia | \$5,869,968<br><br>\$2,934,984<br>cash<br>\$2,934,984 in-<br>kind | Commonwealth<br>Scientific and Industrial<br>Research Organisation;<br>Animal Health<br>Australia; Charles Sturt<br>University; Bureau of<br>Meteorology; Australian<br>Bureau of Agricultural<br>and Resource<br>Economics and<br>Sciences; Australian<br>Government<br>Department of<br>Agriculture and Water                                                                                                                                                                                               | The project will<br>strengthen<br>preparedness<br>and facilitate a<br>return to trade<br>for Australia in<br>the event of an<br>emergency<br>animal disease<br>(EAD) incursion,<br>using Foot and<br>Mouth Disease as<br>a model. The<br>project will take                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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| Advanced measurement technologies for globally competitive Australian meat | Meat and Livestock Australia | \$4,850,000 | \$4,255,000 cash<br>\$2,842,000 in-kind | Resources – Animal Health Policy Branch. | a strong multi-disciplinary approach, working closely with animal industries to deliver a systems based approach to optimise EAD management systems in Australia.<br><br>The project will enable beef, Australian Pork Limited; Scott Technology Ltd; Murdoch University; University of Technology Sydney; WA Department of Agriculture and Food; VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; NSW Department of Primary Industries; South Australian Research and Development Institute; JBS Australia; Australian Cattle and Beef Holdings; Australian Country Choice Pty Ltd; Teys Australia Management Pty Ltd; Harvey Beed; Carometec; PorkScan Private; University of Melbourne; Australian Meat Processor Corporation |
|                                                                            |                              |             |                                         |                                          | sheep and pig farmers to have access to more accurate measurements of meat produce to inform and improve decisions on breeding and animal husbandry. The project will deliver advances measurement technologies and enhanced feedback systems to provide producers with new information to improve competitiveness, and profitability in the meat value chain. The project will also capitalise on the cooperation of                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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| Enhancing the profitability and productivity of livestock farming through virtual herding technology | Dairy Australia Limited | \$2,600,000 | \$1,365,000 cash<br>\$1,871,805 in-kind | Meat and Livestock Australia; Australian Wool Innovation Limited; Australian Pork Limited; Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation; Tasmanian Institute of Agriculture at University of Tasmania; University of Sydney; University of New England; University of Melbourne; Agersens Pty Ltd | industry stakeholders to maximise effective decision making, reduce risk and optimise profits.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                                                                                                      |                         |             |                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | The project will evaluate the on-farm application of virtual fencing and herding technology, demonstrate its implementation and extend its benefits across the major livestock industries. Specifically, the project will develop an understanding of the learning, management and ethical challenges associated with the adoption of virtual fencing on farms. The introduction of a change in both pasture management, and the way that livestock are herded and managed, will enable significant productivity and |

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|                                                            |                                                |             |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | profitability gains for Australia's pastoral farmers. The project will investigate the use of technology such as robotics and improve the way oysters can be delivered to customers. The project will develop innovative systems to open and reseal oysters making them easily opened and extending the shelf life by allowing the oyster to be kept alive for a longer time between opening and consumption. |
| Easy-Open Oysters                                          | Fisheries Research and Development Corporation | \$236,275   | \$193,325 cash<br>\$57,950 in-kind    | Australian Seafood Cooperative Research Centre; SCOTT Pty Ltd; Oyster Bob Pty Ltd; Angelakis Bros Pty Ltd; Tassal Operations Pty Ltd                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Accelerating precision agriculture to decision agriculture | Cotton Research and Development Corporation    | \$1,397,561 | \$750,000 cash<br>\$1,410,415 in-kind | Meat and Livestock Australia; Dairy Australia Limited; Grains Research & Development Corporation; Sugar Research Australia Limited; Rural Industries Research and Development Corporation (AgriFutures Australia); Australian Wool Innovation Limited; Horticulture Innovation | The project will design a solution for the use of big data in agriculture in order to increase the profitability of producers and improve farming strategies. The project will help producers understand data ownership and access rights and                                                                                                                                                                 |

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| More profit from nitrogen: enhancing the nutrient use efficiency of intensive cropping and pasture systems | Australia Limited; Australian Pork Limited; Wine Australia; Forest and Wood Products Australia; Fisheries Research and Development Corporation; Australian Meat Processing Corporation; Australian Livestock Export Corporation Limited (LiveCorp); Australian Egg Corporation Limited; Australian Farm Institute; Data to Decisions Cooperative Research Centre; University of New England; Griffith University; University of the Sunshine Coast; Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation |             |                  | will increase the adoption of new technologies to improve farm profits.                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
|                                                                                                            | Dairy Australia Limited; Sugar Research Australia Limited; Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited; NSW Department of Primary Industries; Queensland University of Technology; University of Melbourne; Tasmanian Institute of Agriculture; QLD Department of Science, Information, Technology and Innovation; Herbert Cane Productivity Services Ltd; Farmacist Pty Ltd; Southern Cross                                                                                                                       |             |                  | The project will improve the nitrogen use efficiency for the cotton, dairy, sugar and horticulture industries. Farmers will gain a better understanding of the various influences on nitrogen use efficiency, and improved confidence to adopt fertiliser |  |
|                                                                                                            | Cotton Research and Development Corporation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | \$5,889,286 | \$4,170,652 cash | \$5,626,295 in-kind                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |



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|                                                                  |                                    |           |                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | management practices tailored to specific crop requirements allowing greater farm productivity and profitability.                                                                                                                               |
|                                                                  |                                    |           |                                  | University; QLD Department of Agriculture and Fisheries; Sunshine Sugar; University of Queensland; University of Southern Queensland; NT Department of Primary Industry and Fisheries; Cherry Growers Australia; Australian Mango Industry Association | More efficient use and management of nitrogen by primary producers will also result in significant natural resource benefits, with improved soil health, reduced leaching and run-off to creeks and rivers, and lower greenhouse gas emissions. |
| Lifting farm gate profit through high value modular agroforestry | Forest and Wood Products Australia | \$520,000 | \$260,000 cash \$638,674 in-kind | Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation; Private Forests Tasmania; Dairy Australia Limited; Rural Industries Research and development Corporation (AgriFutures Australia); University of Tasmania; Greening Australia; Forico;    | The project will develop new approaches for the introduction of trees in agricultural lands to increase farm profitability. Outcomes will include direct benefits to farmers including shelter for livestock, higher animal                     |

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| Advanced production systems for the temperate nut crop industries | Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited | \$5,000,000 | \$4,450,000 cash<br>\$808,470 in-kind | Almond Board of Australia; VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; South Australian Research and Development Institute; NSW Department of Primary Industries | <p>productivity, resilience to weather events, establishment of floral resources for honeybees, sequestration of carbon, and production of timber resources for sale.</p> <p>The project will develop advanced production systems for nut industries using almonds and walnuts as model crops. Plantings of superior varieties of almond and walnut trees will be established and cultivated using optimal water and soil management strategies.</p> <p>The project will measure the impact of temperate nut production on orchard soils, and develop alternative techniques to enhance overall soil quality, reducing inputs</p> |
|                                                                   |                                           |             |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

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|                                                                                                                    |                                           |             |                                         | and negative impacts. The project will demonstrate how multiple industries can collaborate to form an integrated research program that is capable of delivering advanced change to production systems.                                                                                                                                                         |  |
|                                                                                                                    |                                           |             |                                         | The project will establish a new Mediterranean Fruit Fly (MedFly) facility and undertake research to develop endpoint treatments for killing medfly in horticulture produce. The project will also assist in maintaining and expanding market access to other countries by providing evidence that Australian horticulture exports are not infected by Medfly. |  |
| National Centre for Post-harvest Disinfestation Research on Mediterranean Fruit Fly (Australian Medfly R&D Centre) | Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited | \$1,647,636 | \$1,655,746 cash<br>\$1,763,455 in-kind | Murdoch University; WA Department of Agriculture and Food; QLD Department of Agriculture and Fisheries; Kalang Consultancy Services Pty Ltd                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |
|                                                                                                                    |                                           | \$2,987,635 |                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |

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| Digital technologies for more dynamic management of disease, stress and yield                             | Wine Australia |             | \$4,804,082 cash                      | Cotton Research and Development Corporation; Horticulture Innovation Australia Limited; Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation; Fraunhofer Institute; Tasmanian Institute of Agriculture; Tolpuddle Vineyard; Lastek Pty Ltd; University of Queensland; Australian Wine Research Institute; Accolade Wines; University of South Australia; Barton Vale Technologies; Pernod Ricard Winemakers; Treasury Wine Estates | The project will develop innovative processes and precision technologies for the cotton and grape growing industries. The introduction of new digital technologies will provide for more accurate yield forecasts, earlier disease detection in grapes and cotton and better management decisions about crop condition and nutrient levels. The project will extend the use of the technology by trialling equipment on properties and demonstrating the benefits through the use of extension networks |
|                                                                                                           |                |             |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Mitigation of Climate Change Impacts on the National Wine Industry by Reduction in Losses from Controlled | Wine Australia | \$1,466,000 | \$1,466,000 cash<br>\$723,156 in-kind | Australian Wine Research Institute; VIC Department of Economic Development, Jobs, Transport and Resources; La Trobe University; Cooperative Research Centre for Polymers; Wine Victoria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | The project will generate knowledge and new technologies to inform the development of bushfire risk management activities that are                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

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| Burns and Wildfires and Improvement in Public Land Management                                        |                         |           |                                  |                                                                                                                                                                   | less likely to damage grape and wine production. For example, critical distances which reduce the risk of controlled burns to vineyards will be determined and early warning systems for smoke exposure will be developed to enable the targeted application of protective sprays in vineyards at risk of smoke damage. This project will also assist industry by providing a range of effective tools and techniques to remediate affected grapes and wine to promote the viability of affected business. |
| Enhancing supply chain profitability through reporting and utilisation of peri-mortem information by | Australian Pork Limited | \$711,668 | \$754,905 cash \$259,021 in-kind | Meat and Livestock Australia; Australian Meat Processor Association; South Australian Research and Development Institute; VIC Department of Economic Development, | This project aims to develop standards for the consistent reporting, recording and analysis of peri-mortem information for                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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| livestock producers                                               |                                  |             |                                         | Jobs, Transport and Resources                                                                     |  | beef, sheep meat and pork. This will assist in developing a national approach to reporting peri-mortem information for use by producers, processors, regulators and other key stakeholders and will contribute to streamlining and investments in systems that are commonly used in these livestock sectors. |
|                                                                   |                                  |             |                                         |                                                                                                   |  | This project will improve productivity by providing consistent data to producers for the monitoring of health incidences and enable informed production decisions to be made to maximise yield outcomes.                                                                                                     |
| Enhancing the Sugar Industry value chain by addressing mechanical | Sugar Research Australia Limited | \$3,551,000 | \$1,925,000 cash<br>\$2,649,643 in-kind | Norris Energy Crop Technology; Queensland University of Technology; Sugar Research Institute; MSF |  | The project aims to increase sugar industry profitability by introducing new                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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|                                                          |              |                                                                            | harvesting technologies and information to deliver higher yields and lower milling and transport costs.                                        |
| harvest losses through research, technology and adoption |              | Sugar Pty Ltd; AGTRIX Pty Ltd; QLD Department of Agriculture and Fisheries | The project will deliver new software and harvesting information in real time to improve the harvest management and minimise damage to plants. |
|                                                          |              | \$37,257, 226 cash                                                         |                                                                                                                                                |
|                                                          |              | \$39,754,288                                                               |                                                                                                                                                |
| Totals                                                   | \$52,186,966 | in-kind                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                |
|                                                          |              | \$77,011,514 total                                                         |                                                                                                                                                |

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/innovation/rural-research-development-for-profit/approved-projects-round2>